

English Homework: Session 3 with Ahmet

Student: Ahmet (Gürkan)
Date: March 8, 2026
Estimated Time: 1.5 hours
Next Lesson: Saturday / Sunday

Hi Ahmet,

What an incredible session! You spoke for **46 minutes non-stop** with Kübra — a new personal record! Your answers about invisible superpowers, aliens, and life as a movie showed real confidence and personality. Now let's sharpen the edges. This homework focuses on the grammar points that tripped you up, powerful **idioms for expressing dilemmas**, and some impressive C2 vocabulary to take your English to the next level.

Part 1 Grammar Corrections

(30 minutes)

Instructions: For each grammar point, (a) study the correction, (b) write one new original sentence in the box, and (c) note the rule in your own words.

Grammar Point 1: 'Would rather' — the correct structure

× Session errors: "I would rather to live in İzmir." / "I would rather living in Ankara."

✓ Correct: "I would rather **live** in İzmir than stay in Ankara."

✓ Correct: "I would rather **have retired** earlier than waited longer."

• Remember: 'would rather' is ALWAYS followed by a BASE VERB (no 'to', no '-ing'). For comparisons, use: **would rather [verb] THAN [verb]**.

▷ Write a sentence using 'would rather ... than ...' about a real choice in your life:

Grammar Point 2: Question Formation — 'Where were you born?' (not 'did you born')

× Your question: "Where did you born?"

✓ Correct: "Where **were** you **born**?" (passive — use 'be', not 'do')

✓ Also correct: "When **did** you graduate?" (active verb — 'do' is correct here)

• Use 'did' with ACTION verbs (graduate, start, finish). Use 'was/were' with STATE verbs (born, married, based, located).

▷ Write two questions — one using 'did' and one using 'was/were' — as if asking a new colleague:

Grammar Point 3: Causative Verbs — ‘get someone interested’ vs ‘interest someone’

× Your sentence: “I interest one of my colleagues with collecting data.”

✓ Better: “I **got** one of my colleagues **interested in** collecting data.”

✓ Also: “I managed to get my colleague **on board with** the project.”

• ‘Interest’ as a verb: “The topic *interested* him.” But when *YOU* sparked curiosity — use **GET + person + adjective** (*interested / involved / excited*).

▷ Write a sentence about your work using ‘get someone + adjective’:

Grammar Point 4: Articles — ‘the future’ / ‘the user’ / ‘in the past’

× Session errors: “in futures” / “ready for user” / “in past”

✓ Correct: “In **the** future, AI will change everything.”

✓ Correct: “Roads were less safe in **the** past.”

• Use **THE** before unique / specific things both speakers understand (the future, the past, the government, the system, the user). There is only one — so use **THE**.

▷ Write two sentences: one using ‘the future’ and one using ‘the past’, about your engineering career:

Part 2 Dilemma Writing — Hypothetical Situations

(30 minutes)

Instructions: In today’s session you answered some wonderfully creative questions! Now practise writing those ideas as structured paragraphs. Choose **TWO** of the four dilemmas below and write a short response (4–5 sentences each). Use the phrase starters provided.

Useful phrase starters:

- *If I had to choose between... I would...*
- *On reflection, I think the more difficult option is...*
- *Without hesitation, I would...*
- *It is a tough call, but...*
- *The reason I lean towards... is because...*
- *Weighing up the pros and cons, I believe...*

Dilemma 1: If you were invisible for one day, would you use that power for personal benefit or to try to change something in the world? Why?

Dilemma 2: You once said time is more important than money. But imagine you could earn double your current income by working 14 hours a day. Would you do it? What would you sacrifice?

Dilemma 3: If aliens visited Earth and asked you to represent humanity, would you welcome them openly or be cautious? What is the biggest risk — and the biggest opportunity?

Dilemma 4: You had the choice to stay in a safe government career or start your own business. Looking back, was that the right decision? What would you tell your younger self?

Part 3 Speaking Preparation — Unexpected Questions

(20 minutes)

In our next class, I will ask you some unexpected questions — just like Kübra did! The goal is for you to answer **without pausing too long** and without translating in your head. Prepare your answers below (3–5 sentences each). Speak naturally, as if to a stranger.

Q1: If your life were a movie, what would it be called and why? What genre would it be — and who would play you?

Q2: Kübra asked: if you could instantly master any skill, what would it be? Now go deeper — how would having that skill change your daily life?

Q3: You said you would try to ‘change the system of the world’ if you were invisible. What specifically is broken about the world system that you would fix first?

Q4: Between working for a big organisation and running your own business — which is the better choice for a 30-year-old engineer in Turkey today? Give reasons.

Part 4 Bonus Vocabulary: Idioms, Expressions & C2 Words

(20 minutes)

These words and expressions are directly linked to the themes of today’s session: **dilemmas, decision-making, courage, and self-expression**. Try to use **4–5 of them** in your homework answers above!

Section A — Idioms & Expressions

#	Idiom / Expression	Meaning	Example from our session
1	Sit on the fence	Avoid making a decision	You were diplomatic between Egypt and Turkey — sitting on the fence.
2	Bite the bullet	Do something hard that you have been avoiding	Starting Geopave after retirement was biting the bullet.
3	Between a rock and a hard place	Stuck between two equally difficult choices	Choosing between KGM's security and freedom was this.
4	A blessing in disguise	Something bad that turns out to be good	Your knee injury gave you time to re-think your future.
5	Burn your bridges	Permanently damage a relationship / close off a path	You left KGM but didn't burn your bridges.
6	Take the bull by the horns	Deal with difficulty directly and confidently	Starting your own company was taking the bull by the horns.
7	The tip of the iceberg	A small visible part of a much bigger problem	Turkey's data problem is just the tip of the iceberg.
8	Cross that bridge when we come to it	Deal with a problem when it actually arrives	"No photos yet — we'll cross that bridge when we come to it."
9	Weigh up the pros and cons	Carefully consider advantages and disadvantages	A good engineer weighs up the pros and cons before choosing.
10	Go out on a limb	Take a risk others might not support	Publishing your own pavement guide was going out on a limb.

Section B — Advanced C2 Vocabulary

#	Word	Example from class	Synonyms / Notes
1	Conundrum (noun)	Choosing between government and private work is a real conundrum.	Dilemma, puzzle, predicament
2	Predicament (noun)	Engineers face a predicament when data is not released.	Difficult situation, tight spot, quandary
3	Deliberate (verb)	Before leaving KGM, you must have deliberated for a long time.	To weigh up, to mull over, to consider carefully
4	Contentious (adjective)	Data sharing is a contentious issue in Turkish government.	Controversial, disputed, debatable
5	Pragmatic (adjective)	Your approach to road maintenance is pragmatic and results-focused.	Practical, realistic, down-to-earth
6	Mitigate (verb)	Better data would help mitigate the risk of expensive repairs.	To reduce, to lessen, to minimise
7	Audacious (adjective)	Starting a company after 30 years at KGM was truly audacious.	Bold, daring; stronger than 'brave'
8	Reconcile (verb)	It is hard to reconcile freedom with financial security.	To balance two opposing things
9	Unprecedented (adjective)	46 minutes non-stop was unprecedented for you at this stage!	Never seen before, record-breaking
10	Prerogative (noun)	It is your prerogative to decide when and how to retire.	A right or privilege belonging to a specific person

★ Mini Challenge

(10 minutes)

Choose **3 words or idioms** from the tables above and write one sentence each, related to your work, career decisions, or personal life.

1. Word / Idiom:

Sentence:

2. Word / Idiom:

Sentence:

3. Word / Idiom:

Sentence: